

## Sentence Structure

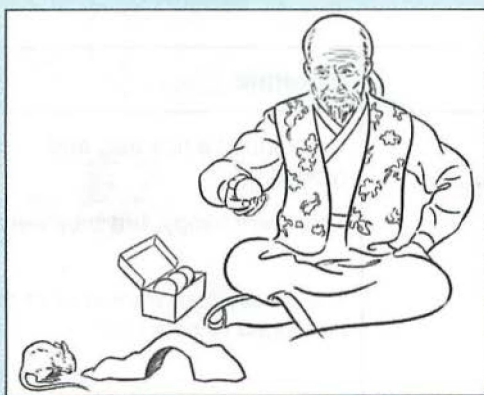
The model for this section is a folktale. A folktale is a traditional story that has been passed down orally from one generation to the next until someone finally writes it down. Every culture is rich in folktales. This one is from Japan.

### MODEL

#### Compound Sentences

#### *Omusubi Kororin (The Tumbling Rice Balls) A Folktale from Japan*

<sup>1</sup>Once upon a time, an old couple lived in the countryside. <sup>2</sup>They were happy, but they were poor. <sup>3</sup>One day, the old man went to work in the forest and took his usual lunch of three rice balls. <sup>4</sup>During lunch, he dropped a rice



ball, and it rolled into a hole in the ground. <sup>5</sup>He heard happy singing coming from the hole, so he dropped the other two rice balls into it. <sup>6</sup>Inside the hole, some mice were having a party. <sup>7</sup>They thanked him for the rice balls and invited him to join them.

<sup>8</sup>After a while, the mice told him to choose a box as a reward for his generosity.<sup>2</sup> <sup>9</sup>He could choose a big box, or he could choose a small one. <sup>10</sup>He thought about taking a big box, but he finally chose a small one. <sup>11</sup>Back at home, he and his wife discovered that the box was full of gold coins. <sup>12</sup>A greedy<sup>3</sup> neighbor heard about their good fortune and quickly made plans to visit the same hole. <sup>13</sup>At the hole, he pushed several rice balls into it, and sure enough,<sup>4</sup> the mice invited him in. <sup>14</sup>The greedy man wanted all of the mice's gold, so he pretended to be a cat. <sup>15</sup>He started meowing loudly, and the frightened mice ran away. <sup>16</sup>The gold disappeared with the mice, so the greedy man got nothing, not even a rice ball.

#### Questions on the Model

1. What kind of order does this folktale use?
2. Circle the time order signals and add any new ones to the Time Order Signals chart on page 25.

<sup>2</sup>**generosity:** willingness to give money, time, help, and so on

<sup>3</sup>**greedy:** always wanting more money, possessions, power, and so on

<sup>4</sup>**sure enough:** informal expression that means something happens just as expected

## Compound Sentences with *and*, *but*, *so*, and *or*

In Chapter 1, you learned about simple sentences. A simple sentence has one subject-verb combination. Another kind of sentence is a compound sentence. A compound sentence has two or more subject-verb combinations.

A **compound sentence** is composed of at least two simple sentences joined by a comma and a coordinating conjunction. A compound sentence has this “formula”:

$\boxed{\text{S}}$   $\boxed{\text{V}}$   
 The gold disappeared with the mice,
 

 COORD. CONJ.  
 so
 

 $\boxed{\text{S}}$   $\boxed{\text{V}}$   
 the greedy man got nothing.

There are seven coordinating conjunctions in English: *and*, *but*, *so*, *or*, *for*, *nor*, and *yet*. In this chapter, you will study the first four.<sup>1</sup>

## Coordinating Conjunctions

| Coordinating Conjunction                                                                                              | Example                                                                           |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <i>And</i> joins sentences that are alike.                                                                            | He dropped a rice ball, <b>and</b> it rolled into a hole in the ground.           |
| <i>But</i> joins sentences that are opposite or show contrast.                                                        | They were happy, <b>but</b> they were poor.                                       |
| <i>So</i> joins sentences when the second sentence expresses the result of something described in the first sentence. | The greedy man wanted all of the mice's gold, <b>so</b> he pretended to be a cat. |
| <i>Or</i> joins sentences that give choices or alternatives.                                                          | He could choose a big box, <b>or</b> he could choose a small one.                 |

Use a comma before a coordinating conjunction in compound sentences only. Do not use a comma to join two words or two phrases in a simple sentence.

### COMPOUND SENTENCES (COMMA)

Yesterday we went shopping, but we didn't buy anything.  
 The stores were crowded, and they were noisy.  
 We ate lunch, and then we went home.

### SIMPLE SENTENCES (NO COMMA)

Yesterday we went shopping but didn't buy anything.  
 The stores were crowded and noisy.  
 We ate lunch and then went home.

## PRACTICE 2

### Compound Sentences with *and*, *but*, *so*, and *or*

- Draw a box around each coordinating conjunction in the story “Omusubi Kororin” on page 29. Explain why some of them have commas, but others don't.
- Decide which of the following sentences are compound sentences and which are simple sentences. Write *CS* or *SS* on the line at the left. Then add commas to the compound sentences.

<sup>1</sup>Coordinating conjunctions are sometimes called *fan boys* because their first letters spell those words: *f*or, *a*nd, *n*or, *b*ut, *o*r, *y*et, and *s*o.

**Monsieur Seguin's Goat**  
**A Folktale from France**

- SS 1. A long time ago, high in the Alps, an old man lived with his goat, Blanchette.
- \_\_\_\_\_ 2. She was a wonderful white goat and was very kind to her master, Monsieur Seguin.
- \_\_\_\_\_ 3. They had lived together for many years.
- \_\_\_\_\_ 4. Blanchette was always fastened to a tree.
- \_\_\_\_\_ 5. She was often sad and sometimes she didn't eat her food.
- \_\_\_\_\_ 6. Every day, she looked at the big mountains and dreamed of being free to explore them.
- \_\_\_\_\_ 7. One day, she asked her master for more freedom.
- \_\_\_\_\_ 8. "You can tie me with a longer rope or you can build a special enclosure for me," said Blanchette.
- \_\_\_\_\_ 9. At first, he tied her with a longer rope, but Blanchette was still sad.
- \_\_\_\_\_ 10. A few days later, he built a special enclosure.
- \_\_\_\_\_ 11. For a while, Blanchette was very happy about this decision but soon the enclosure seemed very small in front of the big mountains.
- \_\_\_\_\_ 12. One summer morning, Blanchette decided to leave for the mountains so she jumped out of the enclosure and ran away.
- \_\_\_\_\_ 13. "I am free," she said.
- \_\_\_\_\_ 14. She ate many varieties of plants and enjoyed meeting new friends.
- \_\_\_\_\_ 15. All day, she ran in the Alps.
- \_\_\_\_\_ 16. Finally, the sun set behind the hills.

- C. For each set of sentences, make a compound sentence or a simple sentence with two verbs. Use the coordinating conjunction *and*, *but*, *or*, or *so* to join the sentences. Punctuate carefully. There may be more than one way to combine some of the sentences.

1. It became very dark. Blanchette was suddenly afraid.

It became very dark, and Blanchette was suddenly afraid.

2. She heard a noise. She decided to go back to her enclosure.
- \_\_\_\_\_

3. She walked for a long time. She couldn't find the road.
- \_\_\_\_\_

(continued on next page)

4. Finally, she became very tired. She tried to rest. Her fear prevented her from sleeping. (Combine all three sentences.)
- 

5. Suddenly, a wolf appeared. The wolf looked at her hungrily.
- 

6. She shouted for help. No one heard her.
- 

7. The wolf ate Blanchette. The poor old man never saw his little goat again.
- 

8. Blanchette wanted to be free. Freedom can be dangerous when we disobey.
- 

- D. On a separate piece of paper, write compound sentences using the coordinating conjunctions you have learned. Follow the directions given.

1. Write a sentence that tells one thing you like to do and one thing you don't like to do. (Use *but*.)

**Example:** I like to swim in the ocean, but I don't like to swim in swimming pools.

2. Write a sentence that tells two things you do every morning after you get up. (Use *and*.)

3. Write a sentence that tells two things you might do during your next vacation. (Use *or*.)

4. Write a sentence that tells the results of each phrase. Begin each sentence with *I am/was*. . . (Use *so* in all three sentences.)

a. being born in (your country)

**Example:** I was born in Russia, so I speak Russian.

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b. being the oldest/youngest/middle/only child in your family

c. being a lazy/hard-working student

5. Write a sentence that tells two different careers you might have in the future. (Use *or*.)

### Try It Out!

Choose one of the following and write a paragraph. In your paragraph, focus on writing compound sentences. Try to use the coordinating conjunctions *and*, *but*, *so*, and *or* at least one time each.

- Retell a short folktale from your culture.
- Retell a children's story that you know.
- Retell the plot of a movie that you have seen recently.



## Punctuation

**Three Comma Rules** Let's review two comma rules that you have learned and learn one new one.

| Rule                                                                                                                                                                           | Example                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Put a comma after a time order signal that comes before the subject at the beginning of a sentence. <i>Then, soon, and now</i> are usually not followed by a comma.         | Yesterday, I did homework for three hours.<br>Finally, I was too tired to think.<br>At 8:00, I fell asleep on the sofa.<br><br>BUT Soon I started snoring.                                      |
| 2. Put a comma after the first sentence in a compound sentence. Put the comma before the coordinating conjunction. (Don't use a comma between two parts of a simple sentence.) | I was too tired to think, so I decided to take a break and watch TV for a while.<br><br>BUT I woke up and finished my homework.                                                                 |
| 3. Put a comma between the items in a series of three or more items. The items may be words, phrases, or clauses. (Don't use a comma between only two items.)                  | I got up, took a shower, drank a cup of coffee, grabbed my books, and ran out the door.<br>Red, white, and blue are the colors of the U.S. flag.<br><br>BUT Red and gold are the school colors. |

### PRACTICE 3

#### Commas

A. In the following sentences, add commas wherever they are necessary.

1. Daisy Tomiko Keiko and Nina live near the college that they all attend.
2. Tomiko and Keiko are from Japan and Nina and Daisy are from Mexico.
3. Nina and Keiko have the same birthday. Both girls were born on June 3 on different continents.
4. Last week the girls decided to have a joint birthday party so they invited several friends for dinner.
5. Nina wanted to cook Mexican food but Keiko wanted to have Japanese food.
6. Finally they agreed on the menu.
7. They served Japanese *tempura* Mexican *arroz con pollo* Chinese stir-fried vegetables and American ice cream.
8. First Nina made the rice.
9. Then Keiko cooked the *tempura*.
10. After that Tomiko prepared the vegetables.
11. After dinner Daisy served the dessert.
12. The guests could choose chocolate ice cream or vanilla ice cream with chocolate sauce.

**B.** Answer each question with a complete sentence.

1. When and where were you born? (Begin your answer with *I was born on . . .*.)

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2. Where do you live now?

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3. Name three of your favorite foods.

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4. What do you usually do on weekends? (Name at least four activities.)

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5. Name one thing that you always do and one thing that you never do on weekends.

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6. What are two or three goals in your life? (Begin your answer with *I would like to . . .*.)

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7. What do you do in the evening? (Begin your answer with *In the evening . . .*.)

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## The Writing Process

### Freewriting

You remember that prewriting is the step in the writing process in which you get ideas. In Chapter 1, you learned about the prewriting technique called *listing*. Another prewriting technique is **freewriting**. When you freewrite, you write “freely”—without stopping—on a topic for a specific amount of time. You just write down sentences as you think of them without worrying about whether your sentences are correct or not. You also don’t have to punctuate sentences or capitalize words. You can even write incomplete sentences or phrases. The main goal in freewriting is to keep your pencil moving across the paper.

Look at this example of freewriting on the topic “A Memorable Event in My Life.”

#### MODEL

#### Freewriting

#### A Memorable Event in My Life

I’m supposed to freewrite for ten minutes about a memorable event in my life. I don’t know what to write about. Maybe about my brother’s boat accident. We were so scared. We thought he was going to drown. He was trapped under an overturned boat and didn’t have any air to breathe. But it ended all right.

He was rescued and had only a broken arm. What else can I write about? Oh! I know. A day I will always remember was the day I left my country to come to the United States. That was a sad/happy day. I felt sad and happy at the same time. Maybe I should write about something happy. Our family vacation last summer was fun. We drove to the coast and camped for a week on the beach. Then there was the day the earthquake happened. Now that was definitely a memorable event. I will never forget it. I was at home with my older sister and little brother. . . .

This writer freewrote until she found a good topic: the earthquake. If she had wanted to, she could have done further freewriting about her earthquake experience to develop this topic.

### Try It Out!

Freewrite about a memorable event or experience in your life. It might be a happy day, a sad event, an embarrassing moment, an interesting trip, or a frightening experience. Write for about ten minutes without stopping. If you find a topic during your freewriting, continue freewriting on that topic. If you already have a topic in mind before you start, freewrite on that topic for ten minutes to develop your ideas about it.

## Review

These are the important points covered in this chapter:

1. Narration is the kind of writing that you do when you tell a story.
2. Use time order words and phrases to show when each part of the story happens.
3. A compound sentence is composed of two simple sentences joined by a comma and a coordinating conjunction.
4. Four coordinating conjunctions are *and*, *but*, *so*, and *or*.
5. Commas are used
  - after most time order signals at the beginning of a sentence.
  - in compound sentences.
  - between items in a series.
  - in dates written in the order month-day-year.
  - in place names.
6. Freewriting is a prewriting technique in which you write without stopping for a specific amount of time.

## Writing Assignment

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Write a paragraph about a memorable event or a memorable experience in your life. Let's review the steps in the writing process.

**Step 1** Prewrite to get ideas. Use the freewriting that you completed in the Try It Out! exercise.

**Step 2** Organize the ideas. Put the events into time order: Make a list of the events or number them on your freewriting paper. Use your list to guide you as you write.

**Step 3** Write the rough draft. Write **ROUGH DRAFT** at the top of your paper.

- Begin your paragraph with a sentence that tells what event or experience you are going to write about.

I'll never forget the day I met my future husband.

The most memorable vacation I ever took was a bicycle trip across Canada.

- Use time order to organize your paragraph. Use time order signals, and punctuate them correctly.
- Pay attention to your sentence structure. Write both simple and compound sentences, and punctuate them correctly.

**Step 4** Polish the rough draft.

- Exchange papers with a classmate and ask him or her to check your rough draft using Peer-Editing Worksheet 2 on page 200. Then discuss the completed worksheet and decide what changes you should make. Write a second draft.
- Use Self-Editing Worksheet 2 on page 201 to check your second draft for grammar, punctuation, and sentence structure.

**Step 5** Write a final copy. Hand in your rough draft, your second draft, your final copy, and the page containing the two editing worksheets. Your teacher may also ask you to hand in your prewriting paper.

### Alternative Writing Assignment

Write a paragraph in which you explain how you celebrate a special day or special occasion in your culture. For example, a person living in the United States might write about Halloween, Thanksgiving Day, or St. Patrick's Day. Follow the writing process steps.